

ENG523 Final-term Current Papers 2026

Short and Long Questions

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SHORT QUESTIONS

1. Corpus and factors used in corpus representation.

A corpus is a large, structured collection of spoken or written texts used for linguistic analysis. It represents real language use in authentic contexts. Corpus representation depends on several factors such as size of the corpus, balance of text types, representativeness of language variety, annotation (tagging of grammatical or semantic features), and sampling method.

2. Phoneme with examples.

A phoneme is the smallest unit of sound in a language that can change meaning. It is an abstract sound category rather than a physical sound. For example, /p/ and /b/ are different phonemes in English because they distinguish words like “pat” and “bat.” Similarly, /k/ in “cat” and /s/ in “sat” show how changing one phoneme changes meaning.

3. How phonemes are used to construct words.

Phonemes combine in systematic sequences to form morphemes and words. Each language has a limited set of phonemes, but their combinations create an unlimited number of words. For example, the phonemes /k/, /æ/, /t/ combine to form “cat.” If one phoneme is replaced, the meaning changes, such as “cat” becoming “cut.”

4. Intonation.

Intonation refers to the rise and fall of pitch in spoken language. It helps convey meaning beyond words, such as emotion, attitude, and sentence type. For example, rising

intonation is often used in questions, while falling intonation is used in statements. Intonation is essential for natural and effective communication.

5. Intonation units and their role.

Intonation units are chunks of speech that carry a single idea or information unit and are spoken with a single intonation contour. They are separated by pauses in natural speech. These units help listeners process information easily by breaking long speech into manageable parts. They also contribute to rhythm and clarity in spoken discourse.

6. Media discourse.

Media discourse refers to the language used in newspapers, television, radio, and digital platforms to communicate information and influence audiences. It is not neutral; it often reflects ideology, power, and social values. Media discourse shapes public opinion by framing events in particular ways and selecting specific linguistic structures.

7. Discourse analysis.

Discourse analysis is the study of language beyond the sentence level. It focuses on how language is used in real communication contexts. It examines spoken and written texts to understand meaning, structure, and social function. It also studies how language reflects identity, power, and culture.

8. Discursive psychology and its principles.

Discursive psychology is an approach that studies how psychological concepts like emotions, attitudes, and identity are constructed through language. Instead of treating thoughts as internal mental states, it analyzes how they are expressed in interaction. Its main principles include treating language as action, focusing on naturally occurring talk, and analyzing how social reality is constructed through discourse.

9. Sociolinguistics.

Sociolinguistics is the study of the relationship between language and society. It examines how language varies based on social factors such as region, class, gender, and context. It also studies language attitudes, multilingualism, and language change in social settings.

10. Sociolinguistics vs interactional sociolinguistics.

Sociolinguistics broadly studies how language varies in society and how social factors influence language use. Interactional sociolinguistics focuses specifically on how meaning is created in face-to-face conversations. It emphasizes context, tone, cultural expectations, and interpretation of spoken interaction.

11. Interactional sociolinguistics and its importance.

Interactional sociolinguistics examines how speakers interpret meaning during communication using contextual cues such as tone, pauses, and cultural background. It is important because misunderstandings often arise due to differences in cultural and social expectations. It helps explain how people negotiate meaning in real-life conversations.

12. Linguistic anthropology.

Linguistic anthropology studies the relationship between language, culture, and society. It explores how language shapes cultural identity and social behavior. It also examines how communication practices vary across cultures and communities.

13. Transitivity in discourse.

Transitivity in discourse analysis refers to how actions, participants, and events are represented in clauses. It shows how language constructs reality by highlighting who does what to whom. It is used to analyze ideology and power in texts.

14. EAP (English for Academic Purposes).

EAP refers to English used in academic settings such as universities and research institutions. It focuses on skills like academic writing, reading research papers, note-taking, and formal communication. It helps learners succeed in academic environments.

15. Academic genre.

Academic genre refers to specific types of academic texts such as essays, research papers, dissertations, and reports. Each genre has its own structure, language style, and purpose. These conventions help maintain clarity and academic standards.

16. Analytical discourse.

Analytical discourse involves examining ideas, arguments, and information in a logical and structured way. It focuses on breaking down concepts and evaluating evidence critically. It is commonly used in academic writing and research.

17. Historical discourse.

Historical discourse refers to language used to describe, interpret, and analyze past events. It is often influenced by perspective, ideology, and available historical evidence. It shapes how history is understood and represented.

18. Cataphoric and anaphoric reference.

Anaphoric reference refers to something mentioned earlier in the text, while cataphoric reference refers to something mentioned later. For example, in “When he arrived, John was tired,” “he” refers forward to “John” (cataphoric). These references create cohesion in discourse.

19. Ellipsis, substitution, and reference.

Ellipsis involves omitting words that are understood from context. Substitution replaces a word or phrase with another like “one” or “do so.” Reference connects words to their meanings within the text. All three are cohesive devices that improve clarity and avoid repetition.

20. Bloor and Bloor on substitution and ellipsis.

According to Bloor and Bloor, substitution and ellipsis are important cohesive devices in discourse. They help reduce repetition and make texts more efficient. Substitution replaces elements, while ellipsis removes them when context makes meaning clear.

21. Subject–verb agreement rules.

Subject–verb agreement means that the verb in a sentence must match its subject in number and person. A singular subject takes a singular verb (e.g., “He plays”), while a plural subject takes a plural verb (e.g., “They play”). In English, agreement is also affected by collective nouns, indefinite pronouns, and intervening phrases, but the main rule remains consistency between subject and verb form.

22. Subject–verb agreement in relative clauses.

In relative clauses, the verb agrees with the antecedent (the noun being described), not the relative pronoun. For example, in “The boy who plays football is here,” the verb “plays” agrees with “boy.” Similarly, in “The students who study hard succeed,” the verb “study” agrees with “students.”

23. According to Winter, clause relationships are signaled by.

According to Winter, clause relationships in discourse are signaled through lexical and grammatical cohesion. This includes conjunctions (and, but, because), repetition of key terms, and logical connectors that show cause, contrast, and sequence. These markers help readers understand how ideas are connected in a text.

24. Halliday’s concept of social meaning in language.

Halliday explains that language carries social meaning because it reflects relationships between speakers, context, and purpose. Language is not only a system of grammar but also a tool for social interaction. Through choices in vocabulary and structure, speakers express identity, status, and interpersonal relations.

25. Fairclough’s concept of discourse (CDA framework).

Fairclough defines discourse as a form of social practice that both shapes and is shaped by society. In Critical Discourse Analysis, language is examined at three levels: text, discourse practice, and social practice. This framework shows how language is connected to power, ideology, and social structures.

26. Main concepts of discourse analytic paradigm.

The discourse analytic paradigm focuses on language in use, context, and meaning construction. Its main concepts include cohesion, coherence, interaction, context, and discourse structure. It also emphasizes how language reflects social and cultural realities.

27. Approaches to discourse analysis.

Major approaches include structural discourse analysis, which focuses on linguistic form; functional discourse analysis, which focuses on meaning and function; interactional analysis, which studies spoken interaction; and critical discourse analysis, which examines power and ideology in language use.

28. Types of discourse analysis projects.

Discourse analysis projects include conversation analysis, media discourse studies, classroom discourse analysis, political discourse analysis, and institutional discourse studies. Each type focuses on different real-life communication settings.

29. Three approaches to media discourse.

The three main approaches are content-based analysis, which focuses on message content; discourse-historical approach, which connects language with historical context; and critical discourse analysis, which examines ideology and power in media texts.

30. Terms of media discourse.

Key terms include framing, representation, ideology, bias, agenda-setting, and narrative structure. These terms explain how media shapes audience perception and constructs reality through language.

31. Idiomatic phrases in media discourse.

Idiomatic phrases in media discourse are fixed expressions used to make communication more engaging and expressive. They help simplify complex ideas and make news more relatable to audiences. Idioms also carry cultural meaning and influence how messages are interpreted.

32. Discourse historical approach.

The discourse-historical approach analyzes texts by linking them to historical, political, and social contexts. It focuses on how meaning is shaped by past events and ideological influences. This approach is widely used in media and political discourse analysis.

33. Factors used to examine social and cultural genres.

Key factors include context of situation, audience, purpose, cultural background, and social norms. These factors help explain how different genres of communication are shaped and interpreted in society.

34. According to Michael, types of social meaning.

Michael identifies three types of social meaning: experiential meaning, which reflects experience; interpersonal meaning, which reflects relationships; and textual meaning, which organizes language into coherent messages.

35. Steps for developing a good research topic.

Developing a research topic involves selecting an area of interest, reviewing literature, identifying a research gap, narrowing the focus, and formulating clear research questions. A good topic should be specific, relevant, and researchable.

36. Content words vs function words.

Content words carry meaning and include nouns, verbs, adjectives, and adverbs. Function words provide grammatical structure and include prepositions, determiners, conjunctions, and auxiliaries. Both are essential for meaningful communication.

37. Relationship between rhythm and beats in speech.

Beats are stressed syllables in speech, while rhythm is the overall pattern created by these beats. Rhythm depends on the regular occurrence of stressed and unstressed syllables, which gives speech its natural flow.

38. Why rhythm is important in teaching spoken English.

Rhythm is important because it improves pronunciation, fluency, and listening comprehension. It helps learners understand stress patterns and natural speech flow, making communication more effective and natural.

39. Faster vs slower speech using intonation units.

In faster speech, intonation units are longer with fewer pauses, making speech more continuous. In slower speech, there are more pauses and shorter units, which improves clarity and comprehension.

40. Beats and rhythm relationship.

Beats form the foundation of rhythm in spoken language. The arrangement of stressed syllables (beats) creates rhythmic patterns that help organize speech and improve intelligibility.



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LONG QUESTIONS

1. Discuss discursive psychology and its three fundamental principles.

Discursive psychology is an approach to studying language that focuses on how psychological themes such as thoughts, emotions, and identities are constructed through discourse. Instead of treating psychological states as internal mental processes, it examines how they are produced and managed in interaction. Its three fundamental principles include treating language as action, focusing on real-life discourse, and analyzing how psychological categories are used in talk. It emphasizes that meaning is created socially through communication rather than existing independently in the mind. This approach is widely used to analyze conversations, media texts, and social interactions.

2. Explain Fairclough's principles of Critical Discourse Analysis (CDA).

Fairclough's Critical Discourse Analysis (CDA) examines the relationship between language, power, and society. It is based on three levels of analysis: textual analysis, discourse practice, and social practice. Textual analysis focuses on vocabulary, grammar, and structure; discourse practice examines production and interpretation of texts; and social practice connects discourse with broader social and ideological contexts. CDA highlights how language reflects and maintains power relations in society. It is widely used to study media, politics, and institutional communication.

3. Discuss discourse analysis approach and its key features.

Discourse analysis is the study of language beyond the sentence level, focusing on how language is used in real communication. Its key features include context dependency, interactional meaning, and the relationship between language and social function. It examines spoken, written, and multimodal texts to understand how meaning is constructed. It also considers how power, identity, and culture influence communication. This approach is widely applied in linguistics, education, and media studies.

4. Explain different approaches to discourse analysis in detail.

There are several approaches to discourse analysis, including structural, functional, interactional, and critical approaches. Structural approaches focus on language form and organization. Functional approaches, such as Halliday's Systemic Functional Linguistics, emphasize meaning and social function. Interactional approaches analyze spoken conversation and turn-taking patterns. Critical approaches, such as CDA, examine power relations and ideology in language use. Each approach provides a different perspective for understanding how language operates in society.

5. Discuss content words vs function words and their role in discourse.

Content words are words that carry meaning, such as nouns, verbs, adjectives, and adverbs. Function words serve grammatical purposes and include prepositions, conjunctions, determiners, and auxiliaries. In discourse, content words provide the main information, while function words ensure grammatical structure and coherence. Both are

essential for producing meaningful and understandable communication. Without function words, sentences lose structure, and without content words, sentences lose meaning.

6. Explain ellipsis and substitution with reference to Bloor and Bloor.

Ellipsis refers to the omission of words that are understood from context, while substitution involves replacing a word or phrase with another element like “one” or “do so.” According to Bloor and Bloor, both are cohesive devices that help avoid repetition and improve text cohesion. For example, in ellipsis: “She bought a car and he did too (buy a car).” In substitution: “I prefer the red pen; I’ll take the blue one.” These devices make discourse more efficient and natural.

7. Discuss why rhythm is important in teaching spoken English.

Rhythm is important in spoken English because it helps learners understand stress patterns, intonation, and natural speech flow. It improves listening comprehension and speaking fluency. Teaching rhythm allows students to sound more natural and be better understood in communication. It also helps distinguish between stressed and unstressed syllables, which is essential in English pronunciation. Overall, rhythm plays a key role in effective spoken communication.

8. Explain relationship between beats and rhythm in spoken discourse.

Beats in speech refer to stressed syllables that carry emphasis, while rhythm is the overall pattern created by these stresses. The relationship between them is that beats form the structural units of rhythm in spoken language. Rhythm depends on the regular distribution of beats across utterances. Together, they help organize speech into meaningful and understandable chunks. This relationship is important for fluency and natural pronunciation.

9. Discuss concept of discourse analytic paradigm with examples.

The discourse analytic paradigm refers to the theoretical framework used to study language in use. It focuses on how meaning is created in context through interaction, structure, and social factors. It includes approaches such as conversation analysis, discourse analysis, and critical discourse analysis. For example, analyzing political speeches or classroom interactions falls under this paradigm. It helps researchers understand how language functions in real-world settings.

10. Explain issues that Critical Discourse Analysis (CDA) explores.

CDA explores issues related to power, ideology, inequality, and social control in language use. It examines how language can reflect or challenge dominance in society. It also studies how media and political discourse influence public opinion. CDA investigates how language constructs identities and social relationships. Overall, it aims to reveal hidden power structures in communication.

11. Discuss how idiomatic phrases are used in media discourse for reference signaling.

Idiomatic phrases in media discourse are used to make communication more engaging, expressive, and culturally relevant. They often carry implied meanings that go beyond

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